

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 25)

Page 122 - The Age of Pope (Minor Works)

Q1. Which poet of the 'churchyard' school wrote the sombre production 'The Grave'?

- A. Robert Blair
- B. William Somerville
- C. Sir Samuel Garth
- D. John Gay

Answer: A

Q2. What is historically significant about Robert Blair's poem 'The Grave'?

- A. It is the longest poem ever written
- B. It is written in blank verse, not in the prevailing classic couplet
- C. It is written entirely in French
- D. It is a comedic farce

Answer: B

Q3. Who wrote the early descriptive poem 'The Chase', which is another specimen of blank verse?

- A. William Somerville
- B. Robert Blair
- C. Sir Samuel Garth
- D. Edward Young

Answer: A

Q4. What is the title of the mock-heroic satire on the Society of Apothecaries written by Sir Samuel Garth?

- A. The Dunciad
- B. The Dispensary
- C. The Rape of the Lock
- D. Trivia

Answer: B

Q5. According to the footnote, what period is roughly covered by the terms 'Classic Age' and 'Augustan Age'?

- A. 1500-1600
- B. 1660-1745 (covering both the Age of Dryden and Age of Pope)

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C. 1800-1900

D. 1200-1350

Answer: B

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Page 123 - Daniel Defoe's Early Life

Q1. Who is the first of the chief prose writers of Pope's age discussed in chronological order?

- A. Jonathan Swift
- B. Daniel Defoe
- C. Joseph Addison
- D. Richard Steele

Answer: B

Q2. What was the profession of Daniel Defoe's father?

- A. A wealthy nobleman
- B. A well-to-do butcher
- C. A printer
- D. A poor farmer

Answer: B

Q3. Which of the following is NOT one of the many varied careers/roles Defoe held during his adventurous life?

- A. King of England
- B. Government spy
- C. Inmate of a Newgate cell
- D. Confidant to the king

Answer: A

Q4. As a born journalist and pamphleteer, roughly how many publications is Defoe said to have written?

- A. 10
- B. 50
- C. More than 250
- D. Exactly 1000

Answer: C

Q5. How did Defoe choose the subjects he wrote about?

- A. He only wrote about theology

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B. He kept his eye on the market, seized on whatever promised to make good 'copy', and turned it to account while popular interest was hot

C. He only wrote poetry about nature

D. He let the King choose all his topics

Answer: B

Q6. Despite his market-driven journalism, what did Defoe avowedly aim to be?

A. A famous poet

B. A moral and social reformer aiming to correct and teach his age

C. A Catholic priest

D. An aristocratic gentleman

Answer: B

Q7. What does Defoe mainly owe his importance in literature to?

A. His political pamphlets

B. His works of fiction (which were an offshoot of his journalistic enterprises)

C. His epic poetry

D. His dramatic plays

Answer: B

Q8. Before writing his famous novels, what kind of works had Defoe been busy manufacturing for years?

A. Cookbooks

B. Lives (biographies) of people who engaged public attention (famous dead men, notorious adventurers, criminals)

C. Scientific treatises

D. French translations

Answer: B

Q9. How were these early 'biographies' by Defoe written?

A. With perfect historical accuracy after years of research

B. At the moment for the moment, loosely put together, with slight regard to accuracy

C. In heroic couplets

D. Only in Latin

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Answer: B

Q10. At what age did Defoe enter upon a new phase of his career by writing prose fiction?

- A. Twenty
- B. Thirty
- C. Sixty
- D. Eighty

Answer: C

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Page 124 - Defoe's Fiction and Legacy

Q1. What famous book did Defoe publish to take the short step from writing biographies with real names to biographies with fictitious names?

- A. Moll Flanders
- B. The Life and Adventures of Robinson Crusoe
- C. Captain Singleton
- D. Colonel Jack

Answer: B

Q2. Which of the following is NOT a work of fiction produced by Defoe after the success of Robinson Crusoe?

- A. The Memoirs of a Cavalier
- B. Gulliver's Travels
- C. Moll Flanders
- D. Roxana

Answer: B

Q3. Why must Defoe's 'Journal of the Plague Year' be classed as fiction?

- A. It features magic and dragons
- B. Though professedly the genuine record of an eye-witness, it is in reality a fabrication
- C. The Plague never happened
- D. It is written as a stage play

Answer: B

Q4. How did Defoe present his made-up stories to the public?

- A. He clearly labeled them as fiction on the cover
- B. He gave them out as true stories and took infinite pains to convince readers of their authenticity
- C. He published them anonymously as jokes
- D. He presented them as dreams

Answer: B

Q5. How does Sir Leslie Stephen best describe Defoe's fictitious biographies?

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- A. 'pure romance'
- B. 'history minus the facts'
- C. 'epic poetry in prose'
- D. 'scientific observations'

Answer: B

Q6. Because Defoe's fictions were thrown into biographical form, what was no attempt made toward?

- A. Making any money
- B. The organization of the materials into a systematic plot
- C. Creating realistic characters
- D. Writing in English

Answer: B

Q7. To give his inventions the air and semblance of truth, how did Defoe tell his stories?

- A. In incredibly elevated, poetic language
- B. In a plain, matter-of-fact, business-like way appropriate to actual life, avoiding artificiality
- C. Only using dialogue
- D. By writing entirely in Latin

Answer: B

Q8. What outstanding feature is universally recognized in Defoe's fiction?

- A. His deep romanticism
- B. His extraordinary minute realism
- C. His complex, twisting plots
- D. His philosophical depth

Answer: B

Q9. What type of style lent itself admirably to Defoe's realistic purpose?

- A. A highly ornate and rhetorical style
- B. A homely, easy, colloquial style
- C. A strict blank verse style
- D. A confusing, metaphysical style

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Answer: B

Q10. While his great importance is universally admitted, what is there some dispute about regarding Defoe?

- A. Whether he ever existed
- B. The exact significance of his contribution to the development of the English novel
- C. Whether he actually wrote his books
- D. Where he was born

Answer: B

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Page 125 - Jonathan Swift's Life

Q1. Who is described as 'by far the most powerful and original genius of his age'?

- A. Daniel Defoe
- B. Jonathan Swift
- C. Alexander Pope
- D. Joseph Addison

Answer: B

Q2. Where was Jonathan Swift born?

- A. London, England
- B. Ireland (of English parents)
- C. Paris, France
- D. Edinburgh, Scotland

Answer: B

Q3. To whom did Swift become confidential secretary in 1689 at Moor Park?

- A. The King of England
- B. Sir William Temple
- C. The Lord Lieutenant of Ireland
- D. Lord Bolingbroke

Answer: B

Q4. When preferred to the Deanery of St. Patrick's, Dublin, in 1714, what cause did Swift espouse?

- A. The cause of the King
- B. The cause of the Irish people (who idolized him so much he virtually governed Ireland)
- C. The cause of the French
- D. The cause of the Puritans

Answer: B

Q5. What physical ailment plagued Swift for many years, eventually leading to his mind giving way in 1736?

- A. Tuberculosis
- B. A mysterious brain disease causing fearful agony and melancholia

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C. Blindness

D. Polio

Answer: B

Q6. Besides his mental disease, what else contributed to Swift's ferociously pessimistic temper and bitterness of spirit?

A. He was very poor

B. The failure of his enormous ambitions

C. He hated writing

D. He was imprisoned for treason

Answer: B

Q7. Who was the most important woman in Swift's life (whose death in 1728 was a blow from which he never recovered)?

A. Arabella Fermor

B. Esther Johnson (Stella)

C. Lady Mary Wortley Montagu

D. Queen Anne

Answer: B

Q8. What document is a wonderful revelation of the real tenderness concealed in Swift's fierce and domineering nature?

A. Gulliver's Travels

B. Journal to Stella

C. A Tale of a Tub

D. The Battle of the Books

Answer: B

Q9. What style of writing was Swift a master of?

A. A highly ornate, Latinised style

B. A simple, direct, colloquial style (far removed from the ornate and rhetorical)

C. Only heroic couplets

D. Complex metaphysical poetry

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Answer: B

Q10. What was Swift's special field, and what was his favorite instrument?

- A. His field was romance, his instrument tragedy
- B. His field was satire, his instrument irony (saying one thing to convey another)
- C. His field was epic poetry, his instrument blank verse
- D. His field was science, his instrument observation

Answer: B

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Page 126 - Swift's Satires

Q1. How does Swift use irony in his 'Argument to prove that the Abolishing of Christianity... may be attended with Some Inconveniences'?

- A. He openly praises Christianity
- B. He nominally adopts a position alien from his own, proceeding gravely to pour ridicule upon the cause he is apparently supporting
- C. He writes a poem about Jesus
- D. He aggressively attacks the church without irony

Answer: B

Q2. Which satire grew out of a controversy concerning the respective merits of ancient and modern literatures?

- A. Gulliver's Travels
- B. The Battle of the Books
- C. A Tale of a Tub
- D. The Dunciad

Answer: B

Q3. What describes 'The Battle of the Books'?

- A. A factual historical account
- B. A mock-heroic description of a great battle in the King's Library between rival hosts
- C. A religious allegory
- D. A romantic novel

Answer: B

Q4. Which book, containing the essence of Swift's thought and style, was designed to champion the Protestant Church and exhibit corruptions of modern Christianity?

- A. Gulliver's Travels
- B. A Tale of a Tub
- C. The Battle of the Books
- D. Journal to Stella

Answer: B

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Q5. In 'A Tale of a Tub', what do the three brothers Peter, Martin, and Jack represent respectively?

- A. England, Scotland, and Ireland
- B. The Roman Church, the English Church, and the Calvinists (dissenters)
- C. Past, Present, and Future
- D. Poetry, Prose, and Drama

Answer: B

Q6. Though Swift said the aim of 'A Tale of a Tub' was to reconcile divinity with wit, what is the general impression left by the terrific satire?

- A. Deep religious devotion
- B. Utter irreverence in the handling of sacred things
- C. Complete boredom
- D. Confusion

Answer: B

Q7. Which of Swift's works stands apart because it is enduringly popular with the general public (like Robinson Crusoe) rather than just students?

- A. The Battle of the Books
- B. Gulliver's Travels
- C. A Tale of a Tub
- D. Drapier's Letters

Answer: B

Q8. Are the purpose and spirit of 'Gulliver's Travels' actually different from the rest of Swift's writings?

- A. Yes, it was meant strictly as a children's book
- B. No, they are of a piece with all his writings (though popular, it is still satire)
- C. Yes, it was written by someone else
- D. No, he wrote it as a serious scientific travel log

Answer: B

Q9. Which of the following works was published in 1704?

- A. Gulliver's Travels
- B. The Battle of the Books and A Tale of a Tub

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C. The Rape of the Lock

D. Robinson Crusoe

Answer: B

Q10. How does Swift attack the free-thinkers and insincere professors of current religion in his essay on 'the Abolishing of Christianity'?

A. By directly calling them fools

B. By ostensibly writing as one who admits 'the system of the gospel... is generally antiquated and exploded'

C. By quoting scripture at length

D. By writing an epic poem about them

Answer: B